

Wednesday, 27 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

27° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

26° 14°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

24° 15°

GLASGOW

Overcast

20° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Scottish Parliament endorses SNP call for independence referendum.

The demand was the Scottish government's first item of business in the new parliament.

POLITICS · UK

2

'Bullying' and 'overbearing' behaviour behind abrupt BP chairman removal.

BP declined to comment on whether bullying behaviour was part of the reason for his immediate dismissal.

UK · NEWS

3

Portable charger problems on flights 'on the rise', watchdog warns.

The CAA says 'more awareness' of the fire risks is needed and asks passengers to 'do the right thing'.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

Race Across the World's Jo and Kush set powerful example for young people.

Former teachers in Liverpool said it 'felt like the whole city was rooting' for Jo and Kush.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Rap star Rob Base, known for hip-hop classic It Takes Two, dies aged 59.

The artist is best known for the 1988 Billboard hit It Takes Two, produced with DJ E-Z Rock.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

Olivia Dean brings the curtain down on Radio 1's Big Weekend with 'magic' set.

The British pop star has closed out a star-studded line-up at Big Weekend, which also included Fatboy Slim and Zara Larsson.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 The 2025-26 Premier League season in alternative tables.**
BBC Sport presents some alternative Premier League tables, looking at set-pieces, xG, long shots, and more.
SPORT · UK
- 2 'Magician' Monfils exits final French Open.**
Gael Monfils bows out of his final French Open in the first round, losing in five sets to compatriot Hugo Gaston, as tributes are paid to one of the great tennis entertainers.
SPORT · UK
- 3 London City pursuing Putellas after Barca exit.**
Two-time Ballon d'Or winner Alexia Putellas has announced she is leaving Barcelona after 14 years, with London City Lionesses in pursuit.
SPORT · UK
- 4 24 Hours with Ella Toone coming soon.**
Watch the trailer for a new BBC Sport documentary offering unprecedented behind-the-scenes access to Manchester United and England star Ella Toone as she prepares for her wedding, while still coming to terms with the loss of her father.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 2 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 3 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 4 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 5 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 6 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.
- 7 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 82% of us secretly enjoy doing THIS, even though we'd never admit it. What?

ANSWER: WATCHING NEIGHBOURS THROUGH THE CURTAINS.

Q When asked what they'd grab in a house fire after their pets and family, 40% said THIS. What?

ANSWER: THE PHONE CHARGER.

TALK TOPIC

- **Researchers say the most stressful day to drive in the UK isn't Monday — it's THIS day.**
(Spoiler: it's Thursday.) Talk-back: what day of the week feels longest to you, and why?

- **The 'big shop' is dying — younger Brits are doing 4–6 small shops a week instead.**
Talk-back: are you a one-big-shop person or a daily-corner-shop person? And which one is your partner?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A goldfish at Bristol Aquarium has been confirmed as the oldest in captivity in the UK after celebrating its 23rd birthday last week. Staff say its secret is a 'strict diet and very calm music'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Scottish brewery has begun training rescue dogs to detect over-fermented kegs by scent, with the lead beagle reportedly never wrong in six months.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- **Sharks existed before trees. Sharks have been around for 400 million years; trees only 350 million.**
- **Bubble wrap was originally invented as wallpaper. It flopped, so they pivoted to packaging.**
- **There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on every beach on Earth.**
- **A group of flamingos is called a flamboyance.**
- **The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896 — it lasted 38 minutes.**
- **Your stomach gets a new lining every three to four days. Otherwise it would digest itself.**
- **The first message ever sent on the internet was 'LO' — they were trying to type 'LOGIN' but the system crashed.**
- **An ostrich's eye is bigger than its brain.**

On this day

Day 147 of the year, 218 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Nicaragua); Children's Day (Nigeria); Christian feast day: Augustine of Canterbury; Christian feast day: Blessed Alojz Grozde. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Lisa Lopes, American rapper and dancer (died 2002)
- 1973 — Jack McBrayer, American actor and comedian
- 1970 — Joseph Fiennes, English actor
- 1967 — Paul Gascoigne, English international footballer, coach, and manager
- 1974 — Derek Webb, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1975 — Jamie Oliver, English chef and author
- 1965 — Todd Bridges, American actor
- 1943 — Bruce Weitz, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1984 — The Danube–Black Sea Canal is opened, in a ceremony attended by the Ceaușescus. It had been under construction since the 1950s.
- 1967 — Australians vote in favor of a constitutional referendum granting the Australian government the power to make laws to benefit Indigenous Australians and to count them in the national census.
- 1975 — Dibbles Bridge coach crash near Grassington, in North Yorkshire, England, kills 33 – the highest ever death toll in a road accident in the United Kingdom.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1967 — The U.S. Navy aircraft carrier USS John F. Kennedy is launched by Jacqueline Kennedy and her daughter Caroline.
- 1980 — The Gwangju Massacre: Airborne and army troops of South Korea retake the city of Gwangju from civil militias, killing at least 207 and possibly many more.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2018 — Maryland Flood Event: A flood occurs throughout the Patapsco Valley, causing one death, destroying the entire first floors of buildings on Main Street in Ellicott City, and causing cars to overturn.
-

2006 — The 6.4 Mw Yogyakarta earthquake shakes central Java with an MSK intensity of VIII (Damaging), leaving more than 5,700 dead and 37,000 injured.

- 2017 — Andrew Scheer takes over after Rona Ambrose as the leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 148 of the year, 217 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Croatia); Christian feast day: Bernard of Menthon; Christian feast day: Germain of Paris; Christian feast day: John Calvin (Episcopal Church). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Leland Sklar, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1966 — Roger Kumble, American director, screenwriter, and playwright
- 1946 — William Shawcross, English journalist and author
- 1952 — Roger Briggs, American pianist, composer, conductor, and educator
- 1944 — Patricia Quinn, British actress and singer
- 1994 — Alec Benjamin, American singer and songwriter
- 1978 — Jake Johnson, American actor
- 1970 — Glenn Quinn, American actor (died 2002)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1968 — Garuda Indonesian Airways Flight 892 crashes near Nala Sopara in India, killing 30.
- 1998 — Nuclear testing: Pakistan responds to a series of nuclear tests by India with five of its own codenamed Chagai-I, prompting the United States, Japan, and other nations to impose economic sanctions. Pakistan celebrates Youm-e-Takbir annually.
- 1991 — The capital city of Addis Ababa falls to the Ethiopian People's Revolutionary Democratic Front, ending both the Derg regime in Ethiopia and the Ethiopian Civil War.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2017 — Former Formula One driver Takuma Sato wins his first Indianapolis 500, the first Japanese and Asian driver to do so. Double world champion Fernando Alonso retires from an engine issue in his first entry of the event.
- 1996 — U.S. President Bill Clinton's former business partners in the Whitewater land deal, Jim McDougal and Susan McDougal, and the Governor of Arkansas, Jim Guy Tucker, are convicted of fraud.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
JUNE 2026		FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)	SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5	FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life	FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
JULY 2026		FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
WED 1	Minions & Monsters	FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington	OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU		
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day		

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		